Hi Arpit!
I'm happy to trim the content if you think best.
We could also consider "Read more" tabs to shorten the text visually.
Please send me an updated quote when you have time, once you better understand the time it takes you, considering both websites and the smaller other projects (logo, brochure, sign, A-frame).
I'll try to take some additional pictures this week too of the clinic space and team.

Thank you kindly for your assistance. I can't wait to see it when it is done!
Have a wonderful day!
Heather

CORE CONNECTIONS
PHYSIOTHERAPY



Hi Arpit! I think this logo works really well! It's complimentary to the Core logo, yet different enough. Thank you so much for coming up with this design, as well as for putting together the other options for me to see.

- Do you think we should aim to have the colour saturations the same? Maybe the OPC logo could be a bit softer like the CC logo?
- Should the font for the Ottawa Pessary Clinic be the same or slightly different? It will need to stand out on a front door sign. We could consider a dark navy font.
- Should we try to work in a bit of grey to the OPC logo so the colours match a bit better? Or should we try slightly different but complimentary colours so that they stand out a bit more from eachother?

Menu structure:

We can consider using this menu structure: https://temp.core-connections.ca/.

We can consider using some of the concepts below to elaborate on the brief points on the Home page template.

Understanding the Interconnectedness… (need to expand here)

Understanding the mind-body connection

We understand how working through fear, trauma, anxiety, emotional overwhelm can impact our bodies.

Building body awareness

We integrate principles of somatic education into our practice, helping you develop greater awareness of your body, movement, sensations, breathing, tension, and patterns of response.

Hands-On Physiotherapy

We use skilled touch and movement assessment to listen to and understand what your body is telling us—feeling for areas of restriction, changes in tissue mobility, altered movement patterns, and how different parts of the body move and work together.

Collaborative, Passionate Care

We are a close-knit team of physiotherapists who share knowledge, collaborate on complex cases, and learn from one another. Our different areas of experience and clinical perspectives allow us to draw on the strengths of the team when considering your care

We offer our services in English, French, Spanish, and Telugu.

About Us

Core Connections Physiotherapy has been providing integrated pelvic health and orthopedic physiotherapy since 2008. As a community-based, physiotherapist-owned clinic in the heart of Westboro, we're proud to provide compassionate, hands-on care grounded in clinical excellence, with a commitment to inclusive, gender-affirming and trauma-informed practice.

Our services include:

- Pelvic Health Physiotherapy for women, men, and 2SLGBTQIA+ individuals
- Pre- and Postnatal physiotherapy care
- Orthopedic and Sports Physiotherapy- we are FCAMPT-certified!
- Physiotherapy for Hypermobility and Ehlers-Danlos Syndromes
- Vestibular Physiotherapy

- Physiotherapy for Adults 60+

Our team brings decades of combined clinical expertise, with individual clinicians offering up to:

• 19 years in pelvic health physiotherapy
• 36 years in orthopedic manual therapy & sports physiotherapy

Home

Possible intro blurb:

Welcome to Core Connections Physiotherapy! We have been providing integrated pelvic health and orthopedic physiotherapy since 2008. As a community-based, physiotherapist-owned clinic in the heart of Westboro, we're proud to provide compassionate, hands-on care grounded in clinical excellence, with a commitment to inclusive, gender-affirming and trauma-informed practice.

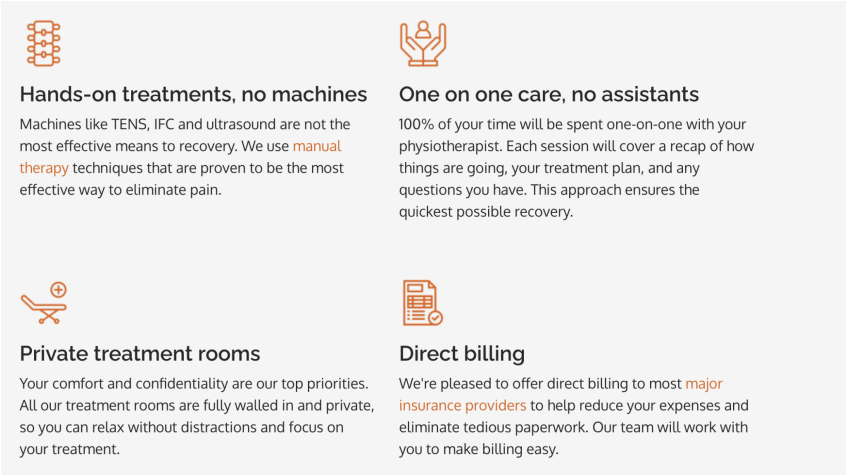
Key phrases we can consider:

- Providing excellence in care in the ♥ of Westboro
- We are celebrating 17 years of serving our community!
- We are a centre of excellence in pelvic health, pre & postnatal and orthopedic physiotherapy.
- We are a community-based clinic focused on inclusive, gender-affirming and trauma-informed care.
    - Our therapists have up to 19 years of experience in pelvic health
    - Our therapists have up to 36 years of experience in orthopedic manual therapy and exercise
    - We offer our services in 4 languages: English, French, Spanish and Telegu.

Picture of the clinic room + additional pictures

**Do we add Service boxes here too?

Perhaps little icons like this from https://www.fxnphysio.com/ using the points below?



Hands-on treatments, no machines

Machines like TENS, IFC and ultrasound are not the most effective means to recovery. We use manual therapy techniques that are proven to be the most effective way to eliminate pain.

One on one care, no assistants

100% of your time will be spent one-on-one with your physiotherapist. Each session will cover a recap of how things are going, your treatment plan, and any questions you have. This approach ensures the quickest possible recovery.

Private treatment rooms

Your comfort and confidentiality are our top priorities. All our treatment rooms are fully walled in and private, so you can relax without distractions and focus on your treatment.

Direct billing

We're pleased to offer direct billing to most major insurance providers to help reduce your expenses and eliminate tedious paperwork. Our team will work with you to make billing easy.

- Skilled, collaborative, experienced team
- Integrated pelvic health and orthopedic care
- Thoughtful, whole-person approach
- Private treatment rooms
- Hands-on, one-on one treatment, no assistants
- Individualized, mindful exercise
- We provide our services in English, French, Spanish and Telugu.

Testimonials & Google Ratings (see example here: https://temp.core-connections.ca/)

Book an appointment button

Heather founded Core Connections Physiotherapy in 2008 out of a deep desire to create a beautiful, community-based clinic and centre of excellence for orthopedic, pre and postnatal, and pelvic health physiotherapy services.

After obtaining her Fellowship in Orthopedic Manual Therapy, she started to become keenly interested in the interconnections of pelvic health. In those early days, in 2008, there was so much to be done to grow pelvic health awareness in Ottawa! She spent years doing community presentations, presenting at conferences, connecting with physicians and other health practitioners in Ottawa, and providing mentoring through the Orthopedic division. Heather's passion for integrated orthopedic and pelvic health care lead her to found Core Connections in 2011 in a sunny, single-room clinic in Wellington West, across from Bridgehead near Holland Avenue.

In 2014, we moved to our beloved home in Westboro, across from MEC on Richmond Road. With its natural light, high ceilings, and warm hardwood floors, the clinic has been a special place of healing, connection, and community ever since.

Over 15 years later, we've grown into a dedicated team of experienced practitioners who truly love what we do! Our diverse clinical backgrounds and shared passion for patient care make Core Connections a very special place. Heather is deeply grateful to work alongside such talented and caring colleagues.

As we continue to grow and evolve our services, we remain profoundly grateful to our dear patients for their trust, kindness, and ongoing support. Thank you for being part of our journey!

Our treatment approach

- Our experienced team works together to provide thoughtful, integrated care grounded in clinical excellence
- Our team of physiotherapists bring decades of knowledge, hands-on skill and passion to their practice.
- Skilled, collaborative, integrative care
- We look beyond symptoms to understand their underlying causes and contributing factors.
- We consider the interconnectedness of the musculoskeletal, pelvic health, fascial, visceral, and nervous systems, alongside broader biopsychosocial influences.
- We use a thoughtful, integrated, whole-person approach
- We integrate sensory-motor awareness training - remapping the brain's internal map through conscious, slow, exploratory movements
- We integrate mindful breathing and movement practice
- Everyone is welcome! We are inclusive and sensitive to the unique needs of people of any ethnicity, gender identity, gender expression and sexual orientation. Our clinic space is calm and beautiful and the treatment rooms are private.

See here: https://core-connections.ca/team/

Join Our Team! 🌿

Pelvic Health & Orthopedics Physiotherapist

Part-time | 15–30 hours/week | Permanent position

Looking for a clinic where you can grow, collaborate, and truly love what you do?

At Core Connections Physiotherapy, you'll work alongside an experienced, supportive team providing thoughtful, hands-on, integrated pelvic health and orthopedic care.

What makes this opportunity exciting?

- A varied caseload including pelvic health, perinatal, orthopedic manual therapy, and vestibular physiotherapy
- Opportunities to deepen your clinical reasoning and develop an integrated, whole-person approach
- Team in-services, ongoing mentorship, and collaborative learning

We'd especially love to hear from you if you have:

- Pelvic health training and ideally 2+ years of experience—or an orthopedic background and enthusiasm for developing your pelvic health skills
- Strong communication skills and a passion for patient-centred care
- 3–5+ years of orthopedic manual therapy experience
- Advanced vestibular training
- English–French bilingualism

Interested? We'd love to meet you! Send your resume and cover letter to reception@core-connections.ca.

Pelvic Health Clinical Mentorship

We offer clinical mentorship in pelvic health physiotherapy within a supportive, collaborative learning environment. Mentorship can be tailored to your experience and learning goals, with opportunities to strengthen clinical reasoning, assessment and treatment skills, and confidence in managing a range of pelvic health presentations.

Our goal is to support your professional growth through shared clinical knowledge, discussion and practical guidance. **Contact us to learn more about mentorship opportunities and how we can support your learning goals.**

We are committed to cultivating a safe, inclusive environment that fosters a sense of connection, hope, and inspiration, where you feel supported and empowered at all times.

Our therapists all share a tremendous passion for helping patients on their pelvic health journeys.

At the heart of our care, we are proud to be able to offer:

Inclusivity: We're proud to be inclusive and sensitive to the diverse needs of all ethnicities, gender identities, gender expression, or sexual orientation.

Clinical expertise: Our pelvic health therapists have up to 18 years of clinical experience in pelvic health.

Trauma-informed care: All of our physiotherapists are trained in trauma-informed care.

Gender-affirming care: Several of our therapists have advanced training in gender-affirming care including:

- pelvic pain
- post-op vaginoplasty
- sexual dysfunction
- dysfunction due to gender-affirming practices (binding, tucking, etc.)

Comfort: Our treatment rooms are private and beautiful.

How is our pelvic health approach integrative?

The richness of our team comes from our therapists – each having a diverse blend of skills, talents and experience – and our ability to collaborate closely together as a team to provide the best possible care we can. Our pelvic health assessments and treatments may include some or all of these approaches:

Pelvic Health Physiotherapy – a gentle and thorough assessment of your pelvic floor may include an internal vaginal and/or anorectal assessment to help us to better understand the source of your symptoms. As a patient, you always have the choice to consent to or defer the internal assessment or to not have an internal assessment at all. We take as much time as it takes to discuss your questions and concerns so that you feel comfortable, safe and supported throughout every step of the assessment.

Orthopedic Physiotherapy – postural and gait analysis, functional movement patterns, assessment and treatment of low back and pelvic pain. For example, a stiff hip can often lead to altered gait and functional movement patterns, low back pain and pelvic floor muscle adaptations.

Integrated Systems Model – a paradigm-shifting approach aimed to identify key factors that are "drivers" and/or contributing factors to your presentation. For example, a flat, pronated foot could be the reason why your rib cage and pelvis are rotated, and this rotation may in turn, alter how your pelvic floor and core muscles engage.

Myofascial Mobilization – gentle, hands-on soft tissue mobilization to restore the mobility of the muscles and fascia (connective tissue). For example, abdominal and pelvic floor muscle scar tissue mobilization, related to c-sections, perineal tears and episiotomies, surgery, or past injury, can significantly improve pelvic floor muscle tone, flexibility, recruitment and strength.

Visceral Mobilization – gentle hands-on techniques to restore the mobility of the pelvic organs – the bladder, uterus and rectum – as well as the mobility of the diaphragm and its related structures, can profoundly improve the function of the pelvic floor.

Pain Science – sometimes the nerves and brain become extra sensitive and keep sending pain signals even after the body has healed. Nervous system desensitization through education, breath work, graded exposure and mindful movement can be very effective.

Our Pelvic Health Approach

We believe great pelvic health care begins with feeling heard, understood and supported. We strive to create a safe, inclusive and welcoming environment where you feel comfortable asking questions, exploring your concerns and taking an active role in your care.

Our approach is integrated, individualized and collaborative. We combine clinical expertise, skilled hands-on treatment, movement and education to understand the interconnected factors contributing to your symptoms and help you move toward meaningful, lasting improvements in your pelvic health and well-being.

What sets our care apart?

Inclusive care

We welcome people of all ethnicities, gender identities, gender expressions and sexual orientations. We are committed to respecting your individual needs, experiences and goals.

Clinical experience

Our pelvic health physiotherapists bring up to 18 years of clinical experience to their practice.

Trauma-informed care

All our physiotherapists are trained in trauma-informed care. We prioritize choice, consent, clear communication and your sense of safety throughout your care.

Gender-affirming care

Several team members have advanced training to support people navigating gender-affirming procedures and practices, including care related to:

- Pelvic pain
- Post-operative vaginoplasty rehabilitation
- Sexual function and dysfunction

- Binding, tucking and other gender-affirming practices

An integrated approach: understanding the bigger picture

The pelvic floor does not work in isolation. Its function is influenced by its relationships with the hips, pelvis, spine, abdomen, connective tissues and nervous system, as well as broader physical, emotional and social factors.

Our strength lies in the diverse skills and experience of our team and our commitment to collaborative care. We look beyond individual symptoms to understand the *interconnectedness* of these systems and identify the key factors that may be contributing to your concerns.

Depending on your needs and goals, your assessment and treatment may incorporate the following approaches.

Pelvic Health Physiotherapy

We conduct a thorough, individualized assessment of pelvic floor function. When clinically appropriate, this may include an internal vaginal and/or anorectal examination. Internal assessment is always your choice: you may consent, defer or decline at any time. We explain each step, welcome your questions and prioritize your comfort, autonomy and ongoing consent.

Orthopedic Physiotherapy

We assess how posture, gait, functional movement and mobility throughout the body may influence pelvic health. Our hands-on approach considers the relationships between the rib cage, diaphragm, spine, hips, pelvis and abdomen. For example, scoliosis may contribute to asymmetries and movement compensations that influence how the pelvic floor and abdominal muscles function.

Integrated Systems Model (Diane Lee)

This approach helps us identify the key factors—or *drivers*—that may contribute to your symptoms. We explore how different areas of the body work together,

including how foot mechanics, hip and pelvic girdle movement, and trunk coordination may influence pelvic floor and abdominal muscle function.

Myofascial Mobilization

Gentle, hands-on techniques may help improve soft tissue mobility and address restrictions associated with scar tissue. Scars following caesarean birth, perineal tears, episiotomies, or pelvic and abdominal surgery may affect local tissue mobility and comfort. When appropriate, scar mobilization can be incorporated into treatment to support movement and pelvic floor function.

Visceral Mobilization

Gentle manual techniques may be used to address the mobility of tissues surrounding the pelvic organs, including the bladder, uterus and rectum, as well as related structures such as the diaphragm. These techniques may complement other aspects of your individualized treatment plan.

Pain Science and Nervous System Education

Pain is influenced by more than tissue injury alone. Sometimes the nervous system becomes more sensitive, amplifying pain and protective responses even after tissues have healed. Understanding these processes can help reduce fear, build confidence in movement and support a gradual return to meaningful daily activities.

Our goal

To help you understand your body, recognize the factors contributing to your symptoms, and feel empowered with the knowledge, skills and confidence to support your pelvic health and overall well-being.

Conditions We Treat

We provide individualized pelvic health physiotherapy for a wide range of concerns, including:

Bladder Health

- Urinary incontinence, urgency and frequency
- Difficulty emptying the bladder

Pelvic Organ Prolapse

- Pelvic heaviness, pressure or bulging
- Support and symptom management

Bowel & Anorectal Health

- Bowel incontinence and urgency
- Difficulty with bowel emptying
- Anorectal and pelvic floor concerns

Pelvic Pain & Muscle Tension

- Endometriosis-related pelvic pain
- Painful intercourse and other forms of sexual pain
- Tailbone, pelvic, hip and persistent lower back pain
- Pelvic floor muscle tension

Sexual Health & Function

- Sexual pain and dysfunction
- Pelvic health concerns affecting sexual function

Pre- & Postnatal Care

- Pregnancy-related pelvic and back pain
- Birth preparation and postpartum recovery
- Abdominal muscle separation (diastasis recti)
- Perineal and caesarean birth scar care

Menopause & Genitourinary Health

- Genitourinary syndrome of menopause (GSM)
- Vaginal dryness, irritation and discomfort
- Urinary and sexual symptoms associated with menopause

Gender-Affirming Care

- Pelvic health concerns related to gender-affirming practices
- Rehabilitation following gender-affirming surgery, including vaginoplasty

Pre- & Post-Surgical Rehabilitation

- Preparation for and recovery following pelvic or abdominal surgery
- Scar mobility and related musculoskeletal concerns

Prenatal Physiotherapy

We're passionate about supporting you throughout pregnancy, preparing you for labour and birth, and helping you recover with confidence postpartum. Our integrated pelvic health and orthopedic approach considers the whole person, helping you address concerns, understand your body and prepare for the journey ahead.

Prenatal Physiotherapy Assessment

Your assessment is individualized to your needs and goals and may include screening for:

- **Pregnancy-related pelvic girdle, back, hip, neck and shoulder pain**
- **Abdominal muscle separation (diastasis recti)**
- **Pelvic organ prolapse symptoms and urinary incontinence**
- **Pelvic floor muscle tension, weakness or coordination difficulties**
- **Scar tissue from previous perineal tears or episiotomies**

We also assess breathing and pressure management, abdominal and pelvic floor function, posture and movement patterns to understand how these systems work together.

Assessments are available in person or virtually at any stage of pregnancy. When clinically appropriate, an in-person assessment may include an internal pelvic floor examination, which is always optional and requires your informed consent.

Prenatal Physiotherapy Services

Depending on your needs, services may include:

- **Pelvic health and orthopedic physiotherapy**
- **Individualized exercise programs and Physioyoga**
- **Breathing, core and pelvic floor rehabilitation**

- **Hands-on manual therapy and scar mobilization**
- **Bladder and bowel health education**
- **Labour and birth preparation, including breathing, movement and birthing positions**
- **Pregnancy and postpartum exercise guidance, including return-to-running planning**
- **Urban poling, hypopressives and yoga ball therapy**

Our Treatment Approach

We look beyond individual symptoms to understand the interconnected factors influencing your comfort, movement and function. Your treatment may combine:

- **Hands-on treatment: Addressing muscle tension, tissue mobility and movement restrictions when appropriate.**
- **Integrated movement and exercise: Improving coordination, strength and confidence through individualized exercises that reflect your goals and daily activities.**
- **Breathing and pressure management: Supporting coordination between the diaphragm, abdominal muscles and pelvic floor.**
- **Education and self-management: Providing practical strategies to support bladder and bowel health, prepare for birth and guide postpartum recovery.**

Our goal is to help you better understand your body, feel confident in its capabilities, and feel supported and empowered throughout pregnancy, birth and postpartum recovery.

Conditions We Treat

- **Pregnancy-related pelvic girdle, back, hip, neck and shoulder pain**
- **Abdominal muscle separation (diastasis recti)**
- **Pelvic organ prolapse symptoms**

- **Urinary incontinence**
- **Pelvic floor muscle tension, weakness or coordination difficulties**
- **Scar tissue from previous perineal tears or episiotomies**

Postnatal Physiotherapy

We're passionate about supporting your recovery after birth, helping you reconnect with your body and return to the activities you love. Our integrated pelvic health and orthopedic approach considers the whole person, addressing the changes associated with pregnancy and birth to support your recovery, comfort and long-term well-being.

Postnatal Physiotherapy Assessment

Your assessment is tailored to your birth experience, current concerns and recovery goals. It may include assessment of:

- Pelvic girdle, lower back, neck, shoulder and upper back pain
- Abdominal muscle separation (diastasis recti)
- Pelvic organ prolapse symptoms and urinary incontinence
- Pelvic floor and abdominal muscle tension, weakness and coordination
- Scar mobility or sensitivity following perineal tears, episiotomy or caesarean birth
- Musculoskeletal concerns related to breastfeeding or chestfeeding

We also assess breathing and pressure management, abdominal and pelvic floor function, posture and movement patterns, and your ability to manage everyday activities such as lifting, carrying and feeding your baby.

Postnatal Physiotherapy Treatment

Your individualized treatment plan may include:

- **Pelvic floor rehabilitation:** Improving muscle awareness, relaxation, coordination and strength.
- **Core and abdominal rehabilitation:** Restoring coordinated function between the diaphragm, abdominal muscles and pelvic floor.
- **Hands-on manual therapy and scar mobilization:** Addressing muscle tension, scar mobility and movement restrictions, when appropriate.
- **Breathing and pressure management:** Supporting coordinated movement and everyday activities.
- **Functional movement and strengthening:** Progressive exercise tailored to your recovery, daily demands and goals.
- **Postpartum education:** Guidance on bladder and bowel health, posture, body mechanics, babywearing and feeding positions.
- **Return-to-exercise guidance:** Individualized progression toward running, sport and other physical activities.
- **Pessary fitting:** Assessment and fitting when appropriate for symptoms of pelvic organ prolapse or urinary incontinence.

Our goal is to help you better understand your body, rebuild strength and confidence, and feel supported in your postpartum recovery and return to the activities that matter to you.

Conditions We Treat

- Pelvic girdle, lower back, neck, shoulder and upper back pain
- Abdominal muscle separation (diastasis recti)
- Pelvic organ prolapse symptoms and urinary incontinence
- Pelvic floor and abdominal muscle tension, weakness and coordination
- Scar mobility or sensitivity following perineal tears, episiotomy or caesarean birth
- Musculoskeletal concerns related to breastfeeding or chestfeeding

Exciting News! Our pessary fitting services have a new name! We're delighted to introduce the **Ottawa Pessary Clinic**, officially opening in January 2027! Visit ottawapessaryclinic.ca for more information.

Orthopedic Manual Physiotherapy

Orthopedic manual physiotherapy combines skilled hands-on assessment and treatment with education and individualized exercise to address musculoskeletal pain, mobility limitations and movement difficulties.

At Core Connections Physiotherapy, our FCAMPT-certified physiotherapists bring advanced post-graduate training and up to 35 years of clinical experience. Our integrated approach considers how joints, muscles, fascia, nerves and movement patterns interact to influence symptoms and function.

We work collaboratively with you to identify factors contributing to your concerns and develop a treatment plan that supports recovery, improves function and helps you return to the activities that matter to you.

FCAMPT-Certified Physiotherapists

FCAMPT-certified physiotherapists have completed rigorous post-graduate training and examination, with an emphasis on advanced assessment skills and clinical reasoning to help distinguish between potential sources of pain and movement dysfunction.

Learn more about the qualification through the Canadian Academy of Manipulative Physiotherapy (CAMPT).

Your Assessment

Your assessment is tailored to your symptoms, health history and goals. It may include:

- **Health and symptom history:** Exploring your concerns, daily activities and goals.
- **Posture and movement assessment:** Observing functional movement, body mechanics and relevant ergonomic factors.
- **Hands-on examination:** Assessing relevant joints, muscles, fascia and nerves.
- **Clinical testing:** Differentiating between potential contributing factors to guide treatment.
- **Collaborative planning:** Developing an individualized approach based on your assessment findings.

Your Individualized Treatment Plan

Depending on your needs and goals, treatment may include:

- **Manual therapy:** Hands-on techniques to address pain and mobility restrictions.
- **Exercise and movement retraining:** Building strength, mobility, coordination and stability for daily activities, work and sport.
- **Breathing, posture and motor control training:** Supporting coordinated movement and physical function.
- **Pain science and nervous system education:** Developing an understanding of persistent pain and strategies for self-management.
- **Education and injury prevention:** Building confidence and skills to manage symptoms and reduce the risk of recurrence.

Our goal is to help you improve comfort, mobility and function so you can return to the activities you enjoy with greater confidence.

Additional Training & Treatment Approaches

Our physiotherapists draw on additional clinical training and movement-based approaches to tailor care to each individual, which may include:

- **Integrated Systems Model:** Diane Lee
- **Advanced orthopedic assessment and manual therapy**
- **Shoulder rehabilitation:** Lyn Watson
- **Cervical spine assessment and rehabilitation**
- **Hip stability training:** David Lindsay
- **Vestibular rehabilitation:** Dizziness, vertigo and balance
- **Dry needling and acupuncture**
- **Pain science and nervous system education**
- **Exercise programming and functional movement retraining**
- **Mindful movement, yoga and Swiss ball exercise**
- **Yoga Tune Up® and Urban Poling**
- **Return-to-running and sport-specific rehabilitation**

Conditions We Treat

Head, Neck & Shoulder

- Headaches

- Neck and shoulder pain

Back & Pelvic Girdle

- Mid-back (thoracic) pain
- Low back and sacroiliac joint pain

Nerve-Related Symptoms

- Sciatica and other nerve-related symptoms

Hip, Knee, Foot & Ankle

- Hip and knee osteoarthritis
- Foot and ankle pain

Posture & Movement

- Postural and movement-related concerns
- Repetitive strain injuries

Sports & Physical Activity

- Sports injuries
- Return-to-activity rehabilitation

Persistent Pain

- Fibromyalgia and persistent widespread pain

Bone Health

- Osteoporosis and osteopenia

Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome (EDS) & Hypermobility Spectrum Disorders (HSD)

Ehlers-Danlos syndromes (EDS) and Hypermobility Spectrum Disorders (HSD) are connective tissue conditions that can affect joint stability, movement, pain and everyday function. Symptoms and their impact vary considerably from person to person.

Ehlers-Danlos Syndromes (EDS)

EDS is a group of heritable connective tissue disorders associated with differences in tissue structure and function. **Hypermobile EDS (hEDS)** is the most common subtype. Other subtypes have distinct features and may involve skin fragility, impaired wound healing or, in certain cases, blood vessel and organ complications.

Common concerns may include:

- Joint hypermobility and instability
- Joint and muscle pain
- Recurrent sprains, strains or joint dislocations
- Fatigue and reduced exercise tolerance

Hypermobility Spectrum Disorders (HSD)

HSD describes symptomatic joint hypermobility that does not meet the diagnostic criteria for hEDS or another specific connective tissue disorder. Symptoms can overlap with those of hEDS, and the impact on daily life can be equally significant.

Common concerns may include:

- Joint pain and instability
- Recurrent sprains or soft-tissue injuries
- Reduced joint control and body awareness
- Muscle fatigue and reduced exercise tolerance

- Difficulty with daily activities or physical exercise

How Can Physiotherapy Help?

Physiotherapy can help people with EDS and HSD improve strength, joint control, confidence with movement and participation in daily activities. Treatment is individualized to your symptoms, abilities and goals, with careful consideration of joint instability, pain and fatigue.

Treatment may include:

- **Strengthening and joint stability:** Gradual, tailored exercises to improve muscular support and control around hypermobile joints.
- **Proprioception and movement retraining:** Developing body awareness, balance and coordination to support more controlled movement.
- **Pain management:** Strategies to manage pain and sensitivity, with gentle hands-on techniques when appropriate and tolerated.
- **Joint protection and activity modification:** Identifying ways to reduce unnecessary joint strain, avoid repeated end-range loading and adapt daily activities.
- **Pacing and exercise progression:** Balancing activity and recovery while gradually building strength, endurance and tolerance for movement.
- **Postural and functional training:** Improving control and confidence during everyday tasks, work, exercise and sport.
- **Scar and soft-tissue care:** Gentle, individualized techniques when scar sensitivity or restricted tissue mobility contributes to symptoms.

An Individualized, Whole-Person Approach

Living with EDS or HSD can involve more than joint hypermobility alone. Our approach considers the interconnected factors that may influence your symptoms and function, including strength, movement patterns, pain, fatigue and the demands of everyday life.

Together, we develop a practical, adaptable treatment plan to help you move with greater confidence, manage symptoms and work toward the activities that matter most to you.

Vestibular Physiotherapy

Vestibular physiotherapy helps assess and treat dizziness, vertigo and balance difficulties. Through individualized treatment, education and exercise, we aim to improve your stability, reduce symptoms and help you return to the activities you enjoy with greater confidence.

Symptoms We Treat

Vestibular physiotherapy may help if you experience:

- Dizziness, vertigo or lightheadedness
- Balance problems, unsteadiness or falls
- Symptoms triggered by head movements or changes in position
- Blurred vision or difficulty focusing while moving
- Persistent dizziness following a concussion or other injury
- Sensitivity to busy environments, movement or visually complex surroundings
- Difficulty walking on uneven surfaces or in low light

Conditions We Assess and Treat

Dizziness and balance difficulties can have many causes. Vestibular physiotherapy may help manage symptoms associated with:

- Benign paroxysmal positional vertigo (BPPV)
- Vestibular neuritis and labyrinthitis
- Concussion and other head injuries
- Whiplash and neck-related dizziness
- Vestibular migraine
- Age-related changes in balance
- Ménière’s disease and other inner-ear conditions

Dizziness can also arise from medical conditions, medication effects or changes in blood pressure. Your physiotherapist will screen for concerns

requiring medical assessment and refer you to an appropriate healthcare professional when indicated.

Your Vestibular Physiotherapy Assessment

Your assessment is tailored to your symptoms and health history and may include:

- A thorough history and screening for medical red flags
- Assessment of head and eye movements
- Balance, coordination and walking assessment
- Specific tests to help distinguish between potential causes of your symptoms
- Assessment of the neck, shoulders and upper back, when indicated
- Blood pressure testing in different positions, if appropriate
- Education and an individualized home exercise program

Some assessment procedures may temporarily reproduce dizziness, nausea or other symptoms. Your physiotherapist will explain the process, monitor your response and adapt the assessment to support your safety and comfort.

Your Individualized Treatment Plan

Treatment depends on the cause of your symptoms and may include:

- **Canalith repositioning manoeuvres:** Specific techniques to treat BPPV by moving displaced inner-ear crystals back to their appropriate location.
- **Gaze stabilization exercises:** Improving coordination between head and eye movements to support clear vision during movement.
- **Balance and coordination training:** Improving stability and confidence during everyday activities.
- **Motion sensitivity exercises:** Gradually building tolerance to movements or visual environments that trigger symptoms.

- **Neck physiotherapy:** Manual therapy, exercise and other appropriate techniques to address neck pain, stiffness and related movement difficulties.
- **Strengthening and conditioning:** Rebuilding physical capacity and supporting a return to meaningful activities.
- **Education and self-management:** Helping you understand your symptoms and manage them between appointments.

Your physiotherapist will adapt your treatment and progress exercises according to your response and goals.

Frequently Asked Questions

How long does it take to improve?

Recovery depends on the underlying cause, symptom duration and individual circumstances. Some cases of BPPV improve within one to three treatment sessions, while other conditions may require several weeks or months of rehabilitation.

What is the difference between dizziness and vertigo?

Dizziness is a broad term that can describe lightheadedness, unsteadiness, disorientation or a floating sensation.

Vertigo is the sensation that you or your surroundings are moving when they are not—for example, feeling that the room is spinning or rocking.

Both symptoms can have several possible causes, which is why a thorough assessment is important.

Can the neck or inner ear cause dizziness?

Yes. The vestibular system in the inner ear helps your brain interpret movement and maintain balance. Conditions affecting this system can cause dizziness, vertigo, visual disturbance and unsteadiness.

Neck pain or injury may also contribute to dizziness in some people. Vestibular physiotherapists assess potential vestibular, musculoskeletal and other contributing factors and recommend medical assessment when appropriate.

What treatments can help dizziness and nausea?

Treatment depends on the cause. Repositioning manoeuvres may help BPPV, while gaze stabilization, balance training and graded exposure to movement may help other vestibular conditions. When neck dysfunction contributes to symptoms, treatment may include manual therapy and exercise.

Your physiotherapist will select and progress treatment according to your presentation and tolerance.

Will dizziness improve on its own?

Some causes of dizziness improve over time, and BPPV may sometimes resolve spontaneously. However, symptoms can persist or recur. Assessment can help identify whether targeted treatment, rehabilitation or medical follow-up is appropriate.

Can I drive after my appointment?

Please arrange for someone to accompany you and take you home after your vestibular assessment or treatment. Testing and treatment can temporarily increase dizziness, nausea or unsteadiness, and we cannot predict your response in advance. We recommend arranging a ride with someone you know rather than planning to drive yourself or travel alone by public transit or rideshare.

How can a vestibular physiotherapist help?

A physiotherapist with vestibular training can assess your symptoms, identify findings that may help explain your difficulties, develop an

appropriate treatment plan and refer you to another healthcare professional when further medical assessment is needed.

Staying Strong, Active & Independent

Staying active and maintaining independence are important at every stage of life. Our experienced physiotherapists provide compassionate, individualized care to help you manage pain, maintain mobility, improve strength and balance, and continue doing the things you love.

Our integrated approach combines skilled hands-on treatment, functional movement retraining, exercise and education to address the factors contributing to your symptoms and support your long-term health and well-being.

Conditions We Treat

Arthritis, Pain & Stiffness
Hands-on treatment, individualized exercise and education to help manage joint pain, stiffness and mobility limitations.

Bone Health: Osteopenia & Osteoporosis
Appropriate strengthening, balance and weight-bearing exercise, with guidance tailored to your needs and bone health.

Orthopedic Conditions & Injuries
Assessment and treatment of back, sacroiliac joint, hip, knee and shoulder conditions, nerve-related symptoms, and persistent musculoskeletal pain.

Balance & Fall Prevention
Balance training, functional exercise and movement strategies to improve stability, confidence and safety during everyday activities.

Dizziness & Vestibular Conditions
Vestibular physiotherapy to assess and treat dizziness, vertigo and balance difficulties.

Pelvic Health
Individualized care for urinary incontinence, pelvic organ prolapse and other pelvic health concerns, including pessary fitting when appropriate.

Our Approach

We combine clinical expertise with individualized treatment to help you move with greater comfort, confidence and independence. Your care may include:

- **Advanced orthopedic manual therapy:** Our FCAMPT-certified physiotherapists bring advanced post-graduate training and up to 35 years of clinical experience.
- **Hands-on treatment:** Manual therapy and soft-tissue techniques, when appropriate.
- **Individualized exercise:** Progressive programs to improve strength, mobility, balance and functional capacity.
- **Movement retraining and education:** Practical strategies to support everyday activities, self-management and injury prevention.
- **Vestibular physiotherapy:** Assessment and rehabilitation for dizziness and balance difficulties.
- **Pelvic health physiotherapy and pessary fitting:** Support for pelvic health concerns that may affect comfort, activity and quality of life.
- **Urban Poling:** A walking-based exercise option to support mobility, balance and physical activity.

Our goal is to help you maintain your strength, confidence and independence so you can continue participating in the activities that matter most to you.

Pelvic Floor Biofeedback

Pelvic floor biofeedback uses visual or auditory feedback to help you understand how your pelvic floor muscles are working in real time. By translating muscle activity into cues on a screen or device, biofeedback can help you develop greater awareness of your ability to contract, relax and coordinate these muscles.

When Is Pelvic Floor Biofeedback Helpful?

Biofeedback may be incorporated into pelvic health physiotherapy when you have difficulty sensing or coordinating your pelvic floor muscles.

- **Pelvic Floor Muscle Awareness:** Helps you recognize when you are contracting or relaxing your pelvic floor muscles, particularly if you find these movements difficult to feel.
- **Pelvic Pain & Muscle Tension:** May help you develop awareness of excessive muscle activity and practise relaxing muscles that tend to remain tense.
- **Urinary Incontinence:** Can help you practise pelvic floor muscle contractions and improve coordination as part of an individualized treatment plan.
- **Pelvic Organ Prolapse:** May support pelvic floor muscle strengthening and coordination when appropriate.
- **Bowel Dysfunction:** Can help you practise pelvic floor relaxation and coordination during bowel movements.
- **Postpartum & Post-Surgical Rehabilitation:** May support muscle awareness and retraining following pregnancy, childbirth or pelvic surgery.

Biofeedback is one of several tools that may be used in your treatment. Depending on your needs, it can be combined with individualized exercises, education, movement retraining and hands-on physiotherapy.

Cupping Therapy

Cupping therapy involves placing cups on the skin to create suction. The suction gently lifts the skin and underlying tissues and may be used as an adjunct to manual therapy to address muscle discomfort, restricted movement and areas of scar tissue.

When May Cupping Therapy Be Helpful?

Cupping may be considered as part of an individualized treatment plan for certain musculoskeletal concerns.

- **Scar Mobility:** Cupping around selected scars, including abdominal and caesarean-section scars, may help improve tissue mobility and comfort during movement.
- **Muscle & Joint Discomfort:** May provide short-term relief of muscle tension or discomfort in some people.
- **Movement & Flexibility:** May be used alongside other treatments to support comfortable movement in areas of soft-tissue restriction.
- **Localized Muscle Tension:** May be applied to selected areas of muscle discomfort as part of a broader treatment approach.

Abdominal and caesarean-section scars can sometimes be associated with restricted tissue mobility or discomfort. Your physiotherapist can assess whether scar treatment may be appropriate in the context of your symptoms, including pelvic floor concerns.

Cupping is not suitable for everyone and may cause temporary skin redness, bruising or tenderness. Your physiotherapist will discuss its suitability and your preferences before treatment.

Cupping is an optional component of care and may be combined with other manual therapy techniques, exercise and education. Its benefits vary, and it does not replace active rehabilitation when that is indicated.

Hypopressives for Pelvic Health

Hypopressives combine specific breathing techniques with coordinated postures and movements. The approach emphasizes postural control, breathing awareness and coordination of the deep abdominal and pelvic floor muscles.

Hypopressive exercises typically involve a controlled exhalation followed by a brief breath hold and an expansion of the rib cage. The technique is intended to influence pressure within the abdomen and encourage coordinated activity of the core and pelvic floor muscles.

When May Hypopressives Be Helpful?

Hypopressives may be considered as one component of a broader pelvic health or movement program, depending on your symptoms, goals and clinical assessment.

They may be explored in relation to:

- Pelvic organ prolapse symptoms
- Urinary incontinence
- Abdominal muscle separation (diastasis recti)
- Pelvic floor muscle coordination
- Postpartum recovery
- Postural control and some back-related concerns

Research on the effectiveness of hypopressives for specific pelvic health conditions is still developing, and they may not be appropriate or beneficial for everyone.

Because the technique requires precise breathing and postural coordination, it is best learned with guidance from a trained physiotherapist. We begin with a pelvic health assessment to understand your symptoms, evaluate relevant muscle function and determine whether this approach is suitable for you.

Hypopressives may be combined with individualized strengthening, pelvic floor training, movement retraining, education and other physiotherapy approaches. They are not a substitute for other treatments when those are indicated.

Important: Hypopressives may be unsuitable in certain circumstances, including pregnancy and some cardiovascular or blood pressure conditions. Your physiotherapist will review relevant precautions before recommending them.

Rectal Balloon Therapy

Rectal balloon therapy is a form of sensory and coordination training that may be used in the assessment and treatment of certain bowel and pelvic floor conditions. It uses a small balloon attached to a thin catheter to help you practise recognizing rectal sensations and coordinating the muscles involved in bowel movements.

When appropriate, a trained pelvic health physiotherapist gently inserts a lubricated balloon into the rectum and gradually inflates it with a small amount of air or fluid. This creates a sensation of rectal fullness, allowing you to practise identifying different sensations and responding to them. The procedure is explained beforehand, and your consent and comfort guide each step.

When May Rectal Balloon Therapy Be Helpful?

Rectal balloon therapy may be considered for selected bowel symptoms, depending on your assessment and treatment goals.

- **Difficulty Emptying the Bowels:** May help you practise coordinating abdominal effort with pelvic floor and anal sphincter relaxation when these muscles do not work together effectively.
- **Chronic Constipation:** May support retraining of bowel mechanics when difficulty coordinating the muscles contributes to constipation.
- **Altered Rectal Sensation:** Can help assess and practise recognizing sensations associated with rectal filling when awareness of these sensations is reduced or heightened.
- **Fecal Incontinence:** In selected cases, sensory training may help improve awareness of rectal filling and support bowel management strategies.

What Does a Training Session Involve?

The specific approach depends on your symptoms and assessment. When rectal balloon therapy is appropriate, a session may include:

1. Sensory Awareness

You practise identifying sensations as the balloon is gradually inflated, such as initial awareness of fullness and the urge to have a bowel movement.

2. Sensory Retraining

Depending on your sensory response, exercises may focus on recognizing rectal filling more accurately or developing strategies to manage urgency.

3. Muscle Coordination

You practise coordinating abdominal effort with relaxation of the pelvic floor and anal sphincter, as appropriate to your needs.

4. Balloon Expulsion

When indicated, you may practise expelling the balloon to work on the coordination needed for effective bowel emptying.

Your comfort and consent come first. Your physiotherapist will explain the procedure, discuss its potential benefits, risks and alternatives, and answer your questions. You may decline or stop at any time. When appropriate, rectal balloon therapy can be combined with bowel habit education, toileting strategies and pelvic floor retraining as part of your individualized treatment plan.

Therapeutic Ultrasound

Therapeutic ultrasound uses high-frequency sound waves delivered through a handheld treatment head placed on the skin with a conductive gel. Depending on the settings used, ultrasound can produce thermal or non-thermal effects in the tissues.

It has been used in physiotherapy as an adjunctive treatment for selected musculoskeletal conditions. However, evidence for its benefits varies by condition, and it is not a necessary part of most rehabilitation programs.

How Is Therapeutic Ultrasound Used?

1. Thermal Ultrasound

Continuous ultrasound can generate heat in the tissues being treated. In selected circumstances, this may be used as a preparatory measure before movement or stretching.

2. Non-Thermal Ultrasound

Pulsed ultrasound uses intermittent sound waves to reduce heat production. It has been studied for potential effects on tissue processes, although clinical benefits are not established for many common conditions.

Is Therapeutic Ultrasound Right for You?

Your physiotherapist will consider your symptoms, goals and the available evidence when selecting treatment options. If ultrasound is appropriate, it may be used alongside more active approaches, such as individualized exercise, movement retraining, education and other physiotherapy techniques.

Our approach emphasizes treatments that are appropriate to your needs and support your functional goals. Therapeutic ultrasound is considered selectively rather than used routinely.

Telehealth Physiotherapy

Telehealth or In-Clinic Appointments

Telehealth physiotherapy offers a convenient, flexible way to begin or continue working toward your physiotherapy goals from the comfort of home. It can be particularly helpful for busy parents, people with mobility or transportation challenges, during inclement weather, or when you would like timely guidance.

During a telehealth appointment, your physiotherapist can take your history, observe your posture, breathing and movement, provide education and exercise instruction, and monitor your progress. Depending on your needs, an in-clinic appointment may be more appropriate when hands-on assessment or treatment is important.

Is Telehealth Right for You?

A telehealth appointment may be a good option if you:

- Would benefit from education, exercise instruction or a review of your home program.
- Prefer to receive care from home or have difficulty travelling to the clinic.
- Would like to discuss your symptoms and goals with a physiotherapist.
- Have health-related concerns that make an in-clinic visit less suitable.

An in-clinic appointment may be more appropriate if you:

- Would benefit from hands-on assessment or treatment.
- Are having difficulty managing your symptoms with your current home program.
- Require an in-person assessment to guide your treatment plan.

The best option depends on your symptoms, goals and individual circumstances. Your physiotherapist can help determine the most appropriate approach.

Are you at increased risk from infection?

If you are immunocompromised or have concerns about attending the clinic because of your health, please contact our reception team at **reception@core-connections.ca** or call us to discuss your options. We can help you determine whether telehealth may be appropriate.

Not Sure Which Appointment to Choose?

We're happy to help. Contact our reception team to arrange a **complimentary phone consultation** with a physiotherapist to discuss your needs and the options available.

Frequently Asked Questions

What is telehealth physiotherapy?

Telehealth physiotherapy, also called virtual care, involves delivering physiotherapy services remotely using secure videoconferencing or, when appropriate, a phone consultation. Depending on your needs, it may include a patient interview, movement assessment, education, exercise prescription and follow-up.

Physiotherapists providing telehealth follow the applicable professional standards and practice requirements. Your physiotherapist will determine whether virtual care is appropriate, whether an in-person assessment is needed, and whether your treatment goals can be addressed effectively through telehealth.

Will my insurance cover telehealth physiotherapy?

Coverage varies by insurance provider and plan. We recommend contacting your insurer to confirm whether telehealth physiotherapy is covered and whether a physician's referral is required.

What do I need for a telehealth appointment?

You will generally need a phone, tablet or computer with a camera, microphone and internet connection. If video is not accessible to you, ask us whether a phone consultation is suitable for your needs.

How secure and private is telehealth?

We use a telehealth platform with encryption to help protect your privacy. Please review our Consent to Telehealth Appointments for further information.

Coming soon in 2027!

Conditions We Treat

Pelvic Health Physiotherapy

We provide individualized pelvic health physiotherapy for a wide range of concerns, with care tailored to your symptoms, needs and goals.

Bladder Health

- Urinary incontinence, urgency and frequency
- Difficulty emptying the bladder

Pelvic Organ Prolapse

- Pelvic heaviness, pressure or bulging
- Prolapse-related symptoms and support concerns

Bowel & Anorectal Health

- Bowel incontinence and urgency
- Difficulty emptying the bowels
- Anorectal and pelvic floor concerns

Pelvic Pain & Muscle Tension

- Endometriosis-related pelvic pain
- Painful intercourse and other forms of sexual pain
- Tailbone, pelvic, hip and persistent lower back pain
- Pelvic floor muscle tension

Sexual Health & Function

- Sexual pain or difficulties affecting sexual function
- Pelvic health concerns affecting comfort and intimacy

Menopause & Genitourinary Health

- Genitourinary syndrome of menopause (GSM)
- Vaginal dryness, irritation and discomfort
- Urinary and sexual symptoms associated with menopause

Gender-Affirming Care

- Pelvic health concerns related to gender-affirming practices
- Rehabilitation following gender-affirming surgery, including vaginoplasty

Pre- & Post-Surgical Rehabilitation

- Preparation for and recovery following pelvic or abdominal surgery
- Scar mobility and related musculoskeletal concerns

Pre- & Postnatal Physiotherapy

Pregnancy and childbirth can affect the pelvic floor, abdominal muscles and musculoskeletal system. Our individualized approach supports comfort, movement and recovery throughout pregnancy and the postpartum period.

Pregnancy-Related Pain

- Pelvic girdle, back and hip pain
- Neck and shoulder pain

Abdominal Muscle Changes

- Abdominal muscle separation (diastasis recti)
- Abdominal strength and functional concerns

Pelvic Floor Health

- Pelvic organ prolapse symptoms
- Urinary incontinence
- Pelvic floor muscle tension, weakness or coordination difficulties

Postnatal Recovery

- Scar tissue following perineal tears or episiotomy
- Recovery following vaginal birth or caesarean birth
- Return to exercise and everyday activities

Pessary Fitting

Pessaries can provide support for pelvic organ prolapse and may help manage certain types of urinary incontinence. We offer individualized pessary fitting and pelvic health physiotherapy through the **Ottawa Pessary Clinic**.

Visit our Ottawa Pessary Clinic website to learn more about our pessary fitting services.

Orthopedic Physiotherapy

We provide individualized orthopedic physiotherapy to address musculoskeletal pain, mobility limitations and movement difficulties, helping you return to the activities that matter to you.

Head, Neck & Shoulder

- Headaches
- Neck and shoulder pain

Back & Pelvic Girdle

- Mid-back (thoracic) pain
- Low back and sacroiliac joint pain

Nerve-Related Symptoms

- Sciatica and other nerve-related symptoms

Hip, Knee, Foot & Ankle

- Hip and knee osteoarthritis
- Foot and ankle pain

Posture & Movement

- Postural and movement-related concerns
- Repetitive strain injuries

Sports & Physical Activity

- Sports injuries
- Rehabilitation to support return to physical activity

Persistent Pain

- Fibromyalgia and persistent widespread pain

Bone Health

- Osteoporosis and osteopenia

Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome (EDS) & Hypermobility Spectrum Disorders (HSD)

EDS and HSD can affect joint stability, movement, pain and everyday function. Physiotherapy is tailored to your symptoms, abilities and goals.

- Joint hypermobility and instability
- Joint and muscle pain
- Recurrent sprains, strains or joint dislocations
- Fatigue and reduced exercise tolerance
- Difficulties with joint control, balance or everyday activities

Our approach may include individualized strengthening, joint stability and movement retraining, activity modification, pacing and strategies to support participation in daily life.

Vestibular Physiotherapy

Vestibular physiotherapy can help assess and manage dizziness, vertigo and balance difficulties. Treatment is tailored to your symptoms, their potential contributing factors and your functional goals.

Vestibular & Inner-Ear Conditions

- Benign paroxysmal positional vertigo (BPPV)
- Vestibular neuritis and labyrinthitis
- Ménière's disease and other inner-ear conditions
- Vestibular migraine

Dizziness & Balance Difficulties

- Dizziness or vertigo triggered by head movement or changes in position
- Unsteadiness and balance difficulties
- Age-related changes in balance
- Motion sensitivity or difficulty in visually busy environments

Concussion & Neck-Related Symptoms

- Concussion and other head injuries
- Whiplash and neck-related dizziness
- Dizziness or balance symptoms following injury

Physiotherapy for Adults 60+

Staying active and maintaining independence are important at every stage of life. Our experienced physiotherapists provide compassionate, individualized care to help you manage pain, maintain mobility, improve strength and balance, and continue doing the things you love.

Arthritis, Pain & Stiffness

- Joint pain, stiffness and mobility limitations
- Osteoarthritis and other musculoskeletal concerns

Bone Health

- Osteopenia and osteoporosis
- Strength, balance and weight-bearing exercise tailored to your needs and bone health

Orthopedic Conditions & Injuries

- Back, sacroiliac joint, hip, knee and shoulder conditions
- Nerve-related symptoms
- Persistent musculoskeletal pain

Balance & Fall Prevention

- Balance difficulties and unsteadiness
- Reduced confidence with walking or everyday activities
- Support to improve stability, mobility and safety

Dizziness & Vestibular Conditions

- Dizziness and vertigo
- Balance difficulties related to vestibular conditions

Pelvic Health

- Urinary incontinence
- Pelvic organ prolapse
- Other pelvic health concerns, including pessary fitting when appropriate

Our integrated approach combines skilled hands-on treatment, functional movement retraining, exercise and education to support mobility, confidence and independence.

Coming soon!

How Is Our Pelvic Health Physiotherapy Approach Integrative?

At Core Connections Physiotherapy, we recognize that pelvic health is connected to the function of the whole body. Pelvic symptoms don’t always have a single cause, and the factors contributing to them may extend beyond the pelvic floor itself.

What makes our approach integrative is the combination of our therapists’ diverse skills, clinical experience and areas of training, together with our commitment to collaborating closely as a team. We look beyond individual symptoms to understand how different systems, movement patterns and experiences may interact and contribute to your concerns.

Your assessment and treatment plan are individualized to your needs, goals and preferences. Depending on your presentation, your care may draw on some or all of the following approaches.

1. Pelvic Health Physiotherapy

Pelvic health physiotherapy helps us assess the function, coordination, strength and relaxation of the pelvic floor muscles, along with other factors relevant to your symptoms.

When clinically appropriate, an internal vaginal and/or anorectal assessment may provide additional information about pelvic floor muscle function. An internal assessment is always optional. You can ask questions,

defer the assessment or choose not to have one. We take the time to discuss your concerns and explain each step so that you feel informed, respected and in control of your care.

Your treatment may include pelvic floor muscle training or relaxation, movement retraining, education, hands-on techniques and strategies to support everyday activities.

2. Orthopedic Physiotherapy

The spine, hips, pelvis, rib cage and lower limbs all contribute to how we move and manage physical demands. Pain, stiffness or altered movement in one area may influence how other areas function.

For example, reduced hip mobility may affect your walking pattern or how you move during everyday activities. These changes may contribute to low back or pelvic discomfort and influence how the pelvic floor muscles work.

By assessing posture, gait and functional movement patterns, we can explore whether orthopedic factors may be contributing to your pelvic health symptoms and incorporate appropriate treatment strategies.

3. Integrated Systems Model

The Integrated Systems Model is an assessment and treatment framework that helps us explore how different parts of the body interact and identify potential key drivers of a person’s symptoms or movement difficulties.

For example, foot mechanics may influence lower-limb movement and the way the pelvis and trunk move during walking. We may explore whether

these patterns are relevant to your symptoms and whether addressing them could support more comfortable, coordinated movement.

Rather than focusing only on the area where you feel pain or discomfort, this approach encourages us to consider the wider movement system and the relationships between its parts.

4. Myofascial Mobilization

Fascia is connective tissue that surrounds and connects muscles and other structures throughout the body. When clinically appropriate, gentle hands-on techniques may be used to address soft-tissue mobility, comfort and movement.

For some patients, this may include working with abdominal or perineal scars related to caesarean birth, perineal tears, episiotomies, surgery or previous injury. Treatment is individualized and may aim to improve scar mobility, reduce sensitivity or support more comfortable movement.

Myofascial techniques may be combined with exercise, movement retraining and other physiotherapy approaches, depending on your needs.

5. Visceral Mobilization

The pelvic organs—including the bladder, uterus and rectum—sit within a network of surrounding connective tissues and are influenced by the movement and pressure changes associated with breathing and everyday activities.

Visceral mobilization involves gentle, hands-on techniques intended to address the mobility and comfort of these tissues. Depending on your presentation, your physiotherapist may also consider the movement of the diaphragm, rib cage and related structures when assessing breathing, pressure management and pelvic floor function.

These techniques are used selectively as part of an individualized treatment plan, rather than as a stand-alone solution.

6. Pain Science and Nervous System Regulation

Pain is influenced by more than tissue injury alone. The nervous system, previous experiences, stress, sleep and other factors can affect how pain is processed. Sometimes the nervous system remains more sensitive after an initial injury or irritation has settled, contributing to persistent pain or discomfort.

Understanding these processes can help make sense of symptoms and guide treatment. Depending on your needs, we may incorporate pain education, breathing strategies, graded exposure to activities, relaxation and mindful movement.

The goal is to help you develop a better understanding of your symptoms, build confidence in movement and gradually return to meaningful daily activities at a pace that feels appropriate for you.

Putting the Pieces Together

Integrative pelvic health physiotherapy is not about using every technique with every patient. It is about understanding your individual presentation, identifying factors that may be contributing to your symptoms and selecting the approaches most relevant to your needs.

Your treatment may combine pelvic floor rehabilitation, orthopedic assessment, hands-on therapy, movement retraining, education and practical strategies for everyday life. We work collaboratively with you, adapting your care as your symptoms, goals and progress evolve.

At Core Connections Physiotherapy, our aim is to provide thoughtful, compassionate care grounded in clinical reasoning, collaboration and an understanding of the interconnectedness of the body.

Your symptoms are important. So is the bigger picture.

Gentle Somatic Education for Pelvic Health

Developing body awareness, easing tension and exploring movement at your own pace.

At Core Connections Physiotherapy, we recognize that pelvic health involves more than muscle strength alone. Breathing, movement, muscle coordination, pain and previous experiences can all influence how we feel in our bodies.

Gentle somatic education focuses on noticing internal sensations and exploring slow, comfortable movements to develop greater body awareness. Rather than focusing on repetitions or perfect technique, the emphasis is on how movement feels and how the body responds.

How Can Somatic Education Support Pelvic Health?

For some people, pelvic health concerns involve difficulty relaxing the pelvic floor, persistent muscle tension or challenges coordinating contraction and release. Somatic approaches may complement pelvic health physiotherapy by helping you:

- Recognize patterns of tension and holding.
- Explore gentle muscle relaxation and release.
- Develop awareness of pelvic floor function.
- Improve coordination between breathing and movement.
- Build confidence in movement at a comfortable pace.

Your symptoms may have several contributing factors, so these approaches are considered alongside your individual assessment and treatment goals.

What Might It Look Like in a Physiotherapy Session?

Depending on your needs, somatic education may include:

- **Breath awareness:** Noticing how your rib cage, abdomen and pelvic region respond naturally to breathing.
- **Gentle movement:** Exploring small, comfortable movements without forcing range or effort.
- **Pelvic floor awareness:** Practising gentle contraction and release when appropriate.
- **Guided attention:** Learning to notice sensations and patterns of tension without judgment.

These strategies may be combined with pelvic floor rehabilitation, orthopedic physiotherapy, movement retraining, education and hands-on treatment when appropriate.

An Individualized Approach at Core Connections Physiotherapy

Our integrated, whole-person approach considers how muscle function, breathing, movement, pain and everyday activities may interact. Gentle somatic education may be one component of care, selected according to your needs, preferences and goals.

You don't need to push through discomfort or have all the answers before beginning. We work collaboratively with you to explore approaches that feel appropriate, respectful and supportive.

To learn more about pelvic health physiotherapy at Core Connections, contact our team to arrange a complimentary phone consultation.

Trauma-Informed Care at Core Connections Physiotherapy

Care grounded in respect, choice, collaboration and trust.

At Core Connections Physiotherapy, we believe that feeling safe, heard and respected is an essential part of receiving care. Our patient-centred, trauma-informed approach recognizes that everyone brings unique experiences, preferences and needs to their physiotherapy journey.

Previous medical experiences, painful examinations, childbirth, surgery or other life experiences can influence how someone feels about physical contact and healthcare. You do not need to share personal experiences to receive thoughtful, respectful care—and you do not need to have experienced trauma to benefit from this approach.

What Does Trauma-Informed Care Look Like?

Listening without judgment. We take time to understand your concerns, goals and preferences, without making assumptions about your body, identity, lifestyle or health choices.

Clear communication and informed consent. We explain assessments and treatments, including what they involve and why they may be helpful. We ask permission before hands-on care, welcome questions and respect your right to decline or withdraw consent at any time. If you ask us to stop, we will stop.

Choice and collaboration. You are an active participant in your care. We encourage you to share what helps you feel comfortable, ask for breaks, request a different approach or have a support person present when appropriate.

Inclusive, respectful care. We strive to provide gender-affirming care that respects each person's identity, privacy, dignity and cultural background. We use clear, accessible language and welcome questions or requests for communication support.

Privacy and comfort. When assessment or treatment involves sensitive areas, we explain each step, discuss options and obtain consent. We use appropriate draping to protect privacy and uncover only the area needed for care.

Trauma-Informed Care in Pelvic Health Physiotherapy

Pelvic health physiotherapy may involve personal conversations, physical contact or, when clinically appropriate, an internal vaginal or anorectal examination. We understand that these experiences can feel vulnerable or unfamiliar.

An internal examination is not something you must agree to simply because it has been recommended. We explain its potential benefits, discuss alternatives and respect your decision. If you choose to proceed, we check in with you throughout, and you can pause or stop at any time.

Working Together at Your Pace

Trauma-informed care is an ongoing commitment to communication, trust, choice and respect. At Core Connections Physiotherapy, we strive to provide compassionate, individualized care grounded in clinical knowledge and collaboration.

You deserve care that respects your voice, your choices and your boundaries.

To learn more about our approach or discuss whether physiotherapy may be right for you, contact our team to arrange a complimentary phone consultation.

Map & Directions

Finding Our Clinic

Core Connections Physiotherapy is located at **363 Richmond Road in Westboro, Ottawa**, just west of Churchill Avenue on the north side of Richmond Road, directly across from Mountain Equipment Company (MEC).

Our clinic has a separate entrance off Richmond Road, beside Frontline Financial Credit Union.

View our location on Google Maps

Public Transit

- **OC Transpo Route 11:** Stops directly outside the clinic.
- **Westboro Station:** The clinic is approximately a 5–10-minute walk from the station, which is served by Transitway routes.

For current routes and schedules, visit OC Transpo.

Parking

Several parking options are available near the clinic:

- **Richmond Road:** Free parking for up to 90 minutes in front of the clinic.
- **Nearby side streets:** Free parking for up to 3 hours on Whitby Avenue and Wilmont Avenue.
- **Paid parking:** Available across the street at MEC and near Westboro Station on Byron Avenue, just west of Roosevelt Avenue.
- **Rear parking lot:** Parking behind the building is available on weekdays after 5:30 p.m. and anytime on weekends. Access is via Madison Avenue through the Frontline Financial Credit Union parking lot.

Accessible Parking

Clients with an accessible parking permit may use the designated accessible parking spaces at the south end of the rear parking lot, accessed from Madison Avenue.

If you have mobility limitations and would benefit from parking closer to the clinic, please let your physiotherapist know in advance so we can help coordinate access to the rear lot.

Driving Directions

From Highway 417 westbound

Take the Carling Avenue exit. Continue west on Carling Avenue, then turn right onto Churchill Avenue. Follow Churchill Avenue to Richmond Road and turn left. The clinic is on your right, directly across from MEC.

From Highway 417 eastbound

Take the Maitland Avenue exit and head north to Carling Avenue. Turn right onto Carling Avenue, then left onto Churchill Avenue. Follow Churchill Avenue to Richmond Road and turn left. The clinic is on your right, directly across from MEC.

From downtown Ottawa

Common routes include Highway 417 westbound (exiting at Carling Avenue), Scott Street to Churchill Avenue, or the Sir John A. Macdonald Parkway via Island Park Drive.

We look forward to welcoming you to Core Connections Physiotherapy!

Connect with Us

We'd love to hear from you! Whether you have questions about our services, would like to book an appointment, or are wondering whether physiotherapy may be right for you, we're happy to help.

Tel: 613-291-2956
Fax: 613-907-1352
Email: reception@core-connections.ca

Location: Westboro, Ottawa, Ontario
Reception Hours: Monday–Friday, 8:30 a.m.–5:00 p.m.

We offer complimentary phone consultations to help you learn more about our services and determine the best next step for your needs.

Contact us today—we look forward to connecting with you!

Book an Appointment

Ready to get started? Book your appointment online at your convenience. If you're unsure which service is right for you, contact us to arrange a complimentary phone consultation.

[Book Online] — link to your online booking page

Follow Us

Stay connected with Core Connections Physiotherapy for clinic news, helpful physiotherapy information, updates and community highlights.

Follow us on Instagram and Facebook!

[Instagram] · [Facebook]

Accessibility

Getting Into the Clinic: Stairs

Our clinic is located on the second floor and is accessible by stairs only.

- Street-level entrance: Three steps with handrails on both sides.
- Staircase to the clinic: One flight of stairs with a handrail on the left when ascending, followed by an additional four steps.

View the outside entrance stairs

View the indoor staircase

If you have difficulty with stairs or are unsure whether you can access the clinic comfortably, please contact us before your appointment. We can discuss options, including telehealth or physiotherapy services in your home.

Accessible Parking & Assistance with Mobility

We have arranged parking options behind the clinic for patients who need assistance with access.

Patients with an accessible parking permit can use the designated accessible parking spaces at the south end of the rear parking lot for the duration of their appointment.

Patients with temporary or ongoing mobility restrictions—including those related to pregnancy, injury, balance difficulties or age-related mobility changes—are welcome to contact us to discuss parking arrangements. Please let our receptionist or your physiotherapist know in advance so we can coordinate with the landlord.

Directions to the Rear Parking Lot

1. From Richmond Road, head north on Churchill Avenue.
2. Turn west onto Madison Avenue.
3. Continue past the church to the parking lot on the south side, marked with a Frontline Financial Credit Union sign.
4. The designated accessible parking spaces are at the south end of the lot.

Communication Accommodations for Patients with Hearing or Visual Impairments

We want to make communication and appointment booking as accessible as possible. Please let us know if you have a hearing or visual impairment that affects how you prefer to communicate, and we will do our best to accommodate your needs.

For patients with hearing impairments who are unable to communicate by phone:

Please email reception@core-connections.ca with the subject line “Request to Book Through Email Only.” Include the type of appointment you are seeking and any communication accommodations you require. We will note your preferences in your profile and communicate with you by email.

Reception email is monitored Monday to Friday, from 8:15 a.m. to 12:15 p.m. and again at approximately 4:00 p.m.

For patients with visual impairments:

Please call reception at 613-291-2956 to let us know about your communication needs. We will note your preferences in your profile and provide appointment details and other relevant information verbally, as needed.

Our goal is to help you feel informed, supported and comfortable communicating with our team.

Other Parking Options

Free Parking

Rear parking lot

- Available on weekdays after 4:30 p.m. and anytime on weekends.
- Access via Madison Avenue, following the directions above.

Nearby side streets

- Free parking for up to 3 hours on surrounding streets, including Lower Byron, Ravenhill and Whitby Avenue.
- Please check posted signs for restrictions.

Paid Parking

Richmond Road — in front of the clinic

Paid street parking is available in front of the clinic. Rates, hours and maximum parking times vary; please check the posted signs or payment machine.

Mountain Equipment Company (MEC) — 366 Richmond Road

- Located across the street from the clinic.
- Listed rate: $1.50 per hour, with a maximum stay of 2 hours.
- Payment by Visa, Mastercard or cash, or through the Indigo Neo app.
- Please confirm current rates and restrictions on-site.

Westboro Station — underground parking at 587 Byron Avenue

- Listed rate: $1.50 per 30 minutes, up to $10 per day.
- Payment through PayByPhone or by credit/debit card at pay stations.
- Approximately a 5-minute walk from the clinic.
- Please confirm current rates and restrictions on-site.

Athlone parking lot — 277 Richmond Road

Paid parking is available at the Athlone lot. Please check the posted rates and payment instructions before parking.

- Approximately a 5-minute walk from the clinic.

Parking rates, time limits and availability may change. Please check posted signs and payment instructions when parking.

Working on this now.

Domain: **ottawapessaryclinic.ca**

- We've been collaborating with specialists, physicians and NCPs and physio clinics in Ottawa and surrounding areas to fit pessaries since 2013

I’ll also need a full resolution file for printing a CC and OPC sign on a dark navy awning above the clinic entrance. I can try to figure out the measurements.

A-frame at clinic entrance, street level with list of services for CC and OPC. I could take measurements and send a picture of the current A-frame we have been using.

Arpit, would you have ideas about how to organize the CC information into a trifold brochure? Please see the version in Canva that we had put together, but never published.